

Whatever happened

After BlackBerry OS 7, and the QNX-based OS for the Playbook, BlackBerry jumped directly to OS 10. Perhaps they wanted a more-rounded number for this new, more-rounded OS. Perhaps they just found 10 to be cooler than 8, or maybe they just felt it was at least 2 versions forward-looking based on the features they added on. Either way, don't look for OS 8 and OS 9, because they don't exist.

What does exist, however, is BlackBerry's biggest change in an OS for quite a while. Built from the ground up with touch-screens in mind, BlackBerry 10 will make earlier BlackBerry users gasp at the differences – put simply, it's light years ahead of the old JAVA-based OS in terms of capabilities.

Earlier Research in Motion used to be the company name, and BlackBerry the name of the OS and the devices they made. With the launch of the new OS – BlackBerry 10 – Research in Motion (RIM) also changed their name to BlackBerry. Things are a lot simpler now, especially for us end-users.

Rough estimates of global market share figures for currently running mobile OSes puts BlackBerry at a little under 3 per cent. This is down from about 20 per cent just a few years earlier. Suffice to say, BlackBerry 10 is what the company's hope rests on.

Understandably, a lot of our readers are interested in the new OS, but also wary, because Android just seems to be the default choice these days. However, Digit's always been about not making default choices, and making sure you know all the aspects, all the options, and have all the information you need to make sure you buy smart.

Have BlackBerry left it too late though? Will they be able to woo users back, and rebuild on what's looking to be a solid new operating system? Only time will tell if BlackBerry 10 can help the company regain some of its lost glory, depending on how you (the buyers) react.

This Fast Track will answer the important questions for you – not by spoon-feeding you the answers, but by giving you the best possible insight